Doctoral Studies

Overview

Azerbaijan Sports Academy (ASA) provides doctoral training in full-time and part-time formats, as well as through the dissertation-based route.

Admission is mainly offered in the following specialities:

- 5806.01 – Theory and methodology of physical education and sports training
- 3245.01 – Rehabilitation medicine, sports medicine, therapeutic physical education, balneology and physiotherapy
- 5312.01 – Sectoral economics

Duration and modes of study

- Full-time Doctor of Philosophy (PhD): 3 years
- Part-time Doctor of Philosophy (PhD): 4 years
- Dissertation-based Doctor of Philosophy (PhD): 4 years

Admission requirements and process

1. Applications are submitted electronically through the Ministry of Science and Education portal, portal.edu.az, in May–June each year.

2. Principal documents include a copy of the master's diploma, the prospective supervisor's written consent, and a list of published research or an essay in the selected speciality.

3. Candidates first take the foreign-language examination administered by the State Examination Centre (SEC), followed by examinations in philosophy and their speciality.

Complete list of required documents

Under the relevant decisions of the Cabinet of Ministers, applications are first submitted through the central education information system (portal.edu.az). Once the electronic application is approved, candidates submit the complete document package to the Academy:

- Personal personnel-record form, together with a workplace-certified curriculum vitae.
- Three photographs, 3 × 4 cm.
- Reference from the workplace (for employed applicants).
- Extract from the employment record book, certified by the employer (where applicable).
- Notarised copies of bachelor's and master's diplomas and their supplements/transcripts; holders of foreign qualifications must also provide a recognition (nostrification) certificate.
- Copy of the identity card of a citizen of the Republic of Azerbaijan.
- List and copies of published research articles and conference abstracts, certified by the scientific secretary in the appropriate format.
- For applicants without publications: an approximately 20–25-page research essay on the selected speciality.
- Written consent or opinion of the proposed academic supervisor from the relevant Academy department, addressing the applicant and proposed topic.

- If available, a valid international foreign-language certificate corresponding to at least CEFR B2 (IELTS, TOEFL, Cambridge English, etc.) for possible exemption from the language examination.

Entrance examinations: programme and question structure

Doctoral admission involves three examination stages.

1. Foreign-language examination (administered by the SEC). The minimum passing score is 25 points. The examination covers:

- Reading comprehension; listening comprehension; grammar and vocabulary; and writing (an essay or text on an assigned topic).

2. Philosophy examination (held at the Academy). Applicants who pass the foreign-language examination are admitted to the philosophy examination, covering:

- The subject, structure and social role of philosophy; being and consciousness and epistemology; historical development, civilisations and culture; contemporary global problems and globalisation.

3. Speciality examination (held at the Academy). This key stage tests the scientific and theoretical foundations of the chosen field. For speciality 5806.01, topics include:

- Methodological principles and methods of sports training.
- Methods for developing speed, strength, endurance and agility.
- Planning and monitoring physical education for different age groups.
- Sports psychology and management of competitive activity.

For speciality 3245.01, topics include rehabilitation medicine, injury rehabilitation, and medical and biological support for athletes.

Doctor of Sciences programme

Training for the Doctor of Sciences degree at ASA differs substantially from PhD training in both duration and admission requirements.

No entrance examinations in foreign languages, philosophy or the speciality are held. Admission is based on the applicant's previous scientific achievements, research experience and submitted documents, through an interview and competitive selection.

Doctor of Sciences: duration and modes

- Full-time: 4 years
- Part-time: 5 years
- Dissertation-based route: 5 years

Doctor of Sciences: principal admission requirements

1. Academic degree: applicants must hold a Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) degree or the former Candidate of Sciences degree.

2. Academic or teaching experience: ability to conduct fundamental research in the chosen speciality and the required scientific or pedagogical work experience.

3. Research publications: following award of the PhD, applicants must have published new scientific articles and monographs in reputable national and international journals, including those indexed in Scopus or Web of Science.